

THE FOREVER PORT GAZETTE

An Honest Word in Every Tide

VORKHARIS TAKES THE LIVING

Disappearances across New Anglia linked to chained convoys, hidden coastal landings, and forced labor beneath the volcanic mountains

FROM THE GAZETTE COASTAL DESK · REPORTS GATHERED IN NEW ANGLIA AND FOREVER PORT



A witness's reconstruction: a covered wagon convoy moving toward New Anglia's ash-darkened heights beneath the sign of the Ash Sovereign.

NEW ANGLIA— What began as scattered reports of missing travelers has become a pattern stretching from coastal hiring yards to the roads beneath New Anglia's volcanic mountains. Carters, healers, quarry hands, smiths, sailors, and solitary travelers have vanished after accepting night work or taking sparsely watched roads. Witnesses now say the missing are being transported alive.

Three independent accounts describe covered wagons traveling inland before dawn with more weight than their declared cargo could explain. One wagon was said to carry empty produce crates while riding low enough to strain both rear axles. Another stopped at an abandoned storehouse where chained people were transferred under canvas.

Those who escaped describe hired coastal gangs supervised by hobgoblin quartermasters. The captors did not speak of ransom. They sorted prisoners by trade and physical usefulness, asking who could shore a tunnel, mend tools, treat burns, work rigging, or crawl through narrow stone passages.

“They did not count names. They counted hands.”

Several witnesses heard the same language: *tithe*, *allotment*, and *mountain contract*. A blackened iron token recovered near one disappearance bore a broken chain curled around a single ember. No lawful New Anglia guild has claimed that mark.

Officials have not produced an order bearing the name of Vorkharis. The Gazette nevertheless finds the connection difficult to dismiss. The routes point toward volcanic labor sites. Hobgoblin officers have appeared at multiple transfers. Survivors heard the title **Ash Sovereign**, and one captor warned that “the mountain remembers every debt.”

Vorkharis has long been associated with destruction, forced service, and movements against human settlements. These new reports suggest a colder purpose than simple raiding. Living prisoners can mine ore, build roads, tend furnaces, crew ships, and march beneath another banner. Every disappearance may strengthen the force preparing the next attack.

New Anglia's decentralized authorities have urged residents not to panic, but local patrols cannot cover every road, quay, and farm track. Fali-City officials have asked for written testimony and physical evidence before committing troops. Families of the missing answer that waiting for perfect proof gives the abductors another night.

Coastal observers have also reported soot-darkened vessels lingering beyond ordinary harbor traffic and sending launches ash without registering cargo. No single ship has yet been formally accused. Harbor crews are asked to note hull markings, unusual lantern signals, and wagons arriving at disused quays after midnight.

TRAVEL IN COMPANY
Record your route. Name your employer. Tell someone when you should return.

WHAT IS KNOWN

- People are disappearing along New Anglia's coastal and inland routes.
- Captives are selected for useful labor and moved alive.
- Covered wagons and unregistered shore launches are involved.
- Hobgoblin quartermasters have been reported at transfers.

WHAT REMAINS UNPROVEN

- The exact location of the labor camps.
- The number of captives or ships.
- Which local officials or merchants are cooperating.
- Whether Vorkharis personally ordered each seizure.

SIGNS TO REPORT

- Wagons riding too low for visible cargo.
- Hidden ventilation holes in side rails.
- Hooded red lanterns carried after midnight.
- Blackened tokens marked by a broken chain and ember.
- Questions about mining, masonry, medicine, smithing, or rigging.

GAZETTE POSITION

Call it rumor if you must. Call it incomplete evidence. But do not call the missing imaginary. Until the roads are safe, every unanswered disappearance is another link in a chain leading toward the mountain.

HARBOR ADVISORY

Masters and crews should challenge unregistered launches, inspect suspicious wagon beds, and report vessels loitering beyond the outer harbor. Do not attempt a rescue alone.